If there are fewer consumers than partitions, each consumer is assigned more than one partition. If the number of consumers is greater than the number of partitions, the additional consumers become inactive.

14.1.2 Detecting consumer failures

Consumers maintain their assignment to their partitions through regular polling. If the consumer does not reach the broker within a certain period of time, its partition is assigned to another consumer in the same group. This duration can be set with `akka.kafka.consumer.poll-timeout`.

The consumer may fail because the connection to the bootstrap servers is not working. To work around this, you can connect to a single bootstrap server that acts as a proxy for multiple brokers. However, it is recommended to specify a list of bootstrap servers to connect to instead of relying on a single proxy. This way, you avoid the single point of failure.

In the previous example, you didn't commit the offset. If you don't, your stream will start at the very end every time you start the application. This probably is not what you want. You usually need to continue reading where you left off. Let's look at one way to do this.

14.1.3 Auto-commit

If auto-commit is set to `true`—the default is `false`—the consumer is committed at regular intervals. This interval is set with `auto.commit.interval.ms`.